The increased authorized capital was only an enabling measure. Raising the actual capital was a daunting prospect. As we saw, not only did VOC practically set up the company, he was the prime mover in raising the resources. His ceaseless travels and stirring lectures across the length and breadth of the Madras presidency were primarily responsible for garnering capital.

VOC's arrest was therefore a double blow. Not only was the impresario who ran the show missing, but there was also no charismatic figure to draw crowds, infuse patriotism and persuade people to part with their money. Given the pressing need of resources for both capital expenditure and operational expenses, all those involved with the company—its directors, employees, well-wishers and volunteers—needed to step in. The company's agents fanned out into the country to canvass for shares.[70] But their task was not easy.

Deterring Investors

Though the exact nature and details of the intrigues against SSNCo by the government at the highest level would not have been widely known, the hostility of the administration was no secret. The public took a dim view of the government's attitude which could not but have influenced their decision to invest. The nationalist press expressed its anger in unvarnished terms.

Governments usually encouraged infant industries, *The Hindu* said, but, in SSNCo's case, it did the opposite. 'The Government will never protect this infant. Even if it does, it will be a stepmother's protection.' If only an Indian were at the helm of the government, the SSNCo would surely have prospered. 'A handful of Europeans threaten a well-meaning national enterprise with extinction. Can it be? Let every Indian answer and let the answer take a substantial shape. The protection that is denied to us by an alien government has to be afforded by the people themselves.' The newspaper's ire turned on the rival company as well. The BI's booking office was accused of misleading prospective passengers by stating they